ECONOMIC ATTITUDE SURVEY II
Top-line Questionnaire
May 8, 1992

Number of interviews = 1,200
Margin of error = + or - 3 percentage points
Dates of interviewing = May 3 - 7, 1992

Jan 1992 data from U.S. News & World Report Economic Survey I.
N=1,500 conducted January 18-21 1992.

INTRODUCTION: Hello, I am _____ calling for the Princeton Survey Research Associates from Princeton, New Jersey. We are conducting a telephone opinion survey for a leading news organization. I'd like to ask a few questions of the youngest male, 18 years of age or older, who is now at home (IF NO MALE, ASK: May I please speak with the oldest female, 18 years of age or older, who is now at home?)

First...

1. I'd like your opinion of some people. As I read from a list, please tell me which category best describes your overall opinion of who I name. First, would you describe your opinion of (ITEM) as very favorable, mostly favorable, mostly unfavorable, or very unfavorable? (ROTATE LIST)

	Very Favorable	Mostly Favorable	Mostly Unfavorable	Very Unfavorable	(VOL) Never Heard of	(VOL) Can't Rate
George Bush	16	37	25	19	*	3 = 100
Bill Clinton	7	32	32	18	4	7 = 100
H. Ross Perot	12	29	15	10	18	16 = 100

2. Suppose 1992 Presidential election were being held today. If George Bush were the Republican candidate, Arkansas Governor Bill Clinton were the Democratic candidate, and Ross Perot were the Independent candidate, who would you like to see win?

3. As of today, do you lean more to George Bush, the Republican, Bill Clinton, the Democrat, or do you lean toward Ross perot, the Independent?

BASED ON SUPPORTERS AND LEANERS

May 1992		April 1992
43	George Bush	40
26	Bill Clinton	29
26	Ross Perot	24
*	Other	2
5	Undecided	5
100		100

***These test election results do not not trend comparably to the results of the Gender poll, the Times Mirror's recent survey, or to the New York Times survey because in this poll we did not first ask respondents if they were aware of Perot's candidacy, or who they preferred for the Dem nomination. Without these prompts the incumbent Bush gets more support.**

4. In general, are you satisfied or dissatisfied with the way things are going in the U.S. at this time?

May 1992		April 1992	Times Mirror Jan 92
21	Satisfied	20	28
76	Dissatisfied	76	68
3	Don't know/refused	4	4
100		100	100

5. What is the biggest problem facing you and your family these days? (OPEN END. DO NOT READ.)

May 1992		Jan. 1992
26	Unemployment/Low paying jobs	28
20	Not enough money/Paying bills/Making ends meet	24
30	Economy/Recession (general)	19
8	High prices/High cost of living and housing	10
8	Health care/High cost of health insurance	10
8	Taxes/High taxes	8
5	Child care/Cost of education	4
3	Family/Personal/Health problems	4
12	Social problems/Racial tension	4
1	Environment	NA
4	Government/Government corruption	NA
10	Other	4
6	No problems	7
1	Don't know	4
142		126

Total exceeds 100% due to multiple responses

6. How would you rate your own personal financial situation. Would you say you are in excellent financial shape, good shape, only fair shape or poor shape?

May 1992		Jan 1992
4	Excellent shape	4
35	Good shape	32
45	Only fair shape	45
15	Poor shape	18
1	Don't know/refused	1
100		100

7. How much do you and your family worry about being able to make ends meet -- a lot, some, only a little, or not at all?

May 1992		Jan 1992
26	A lot	27
35	Some	32
22	Only a little	23
16	Not at all	17
1	Don't know/refused	1
100		100

8. Over the course of the next year, do you believe you and your family's financial situation will be improving a lot, improving some, becoming a little worse or becoming a lot worse?

May 1992		Jan 1992
8	Improving a lot	9
49	Improving some	46
22	Becoming a little worse	19
4	Becoming a lot worse	5
13	Staying about the same (VOL.)	16
4	Don't know/refused	5
100		100

10. Are you employed full-time, part-time or aren't you employed? (IF R SAYS NOT EMPLOYED ASK: Is that because you are retired, because you choose not to work, because you've been laid off or fired and are looking for work, or because you've been laid off or fired and have given up looking for work?)

May 1992		Jan 1992
51	Employed full-time	50
14	Employed part-time	11
20	Not employed - Retired	19
9	Not employed - Choose not to work	12
4	Not employed - laid off/fired and looking	6
1	Not employed - laid off/fired and not looking	1
1	Don't know/refused	1
100		100

11. Do you think the chances are high, low or almost zero that some time in the next 12 months an adult in your family will be out of work and actively looking for a job?

May 1992		Jan 1992
22	High	22
27	Low	24
37	Almost zero	37
3	Someone out of work now (VOL.)	6
7	Retired (VOL.)	7
4	Don't know/refused	4
100		100

ASK ONLY OF EMPLOYED PEOPLE:
12. Do you now earn enough money to lead the kind of life you want, or not?

May 1992		Jan 1992
34	Yes	39
65	No	61
1	Don't know/refused	*
100		100
(852)		(1,002)

IF NO IN QUESTION 12 ASK:
13. Do you think you will be able to earn enough money in the future to lead the kind of life you want, or not?

May 1992		Jan 1992
34	Yes	34
28	No	22
3	Don't know/refused	5
65%		61%
(852)		(1,002)

ASKED Q. 14 EMPLOYED PEOPLE ONLY
14. Overall, how satisfied are you with your job? Are you completely satisfied, mostly satisfied, mostly dissatisfied or completely dissatisfied?

May 1992		Gallup Poll July 1989
20	Completely satisfied	28
63	Mostly satisfied	61
14	Mostly dissatisfied	8
2	Completely dissatisfied	3
1	Don't know/refused	*
100		100
(852)		(669)

ASK Q. 16 OF EMPLOYED AND LAID OFF PEOPLE ONLY

16. What are your expectation about work when you reach age 65. Do you expect to work full time, part time or don't you expect to be working?

May 1992	
14	Will work full time
28	Will work part time
51	Will not have to work
3	ALREADY PAST 65 AND STILL WORKING
4	Don't know/ It depends/refused
100	
(908)	

ASK Q. 17 OF ALL. USE PAST TENSE VERSION IF NOT EMPLOYED IN Q. 10

17. Here are two different ways of looking at your job. Some people get a sense of identity from their job. For other people, their job is just what they do for a living. Which of these best describes the way you usually (feel about your job/felt about your last job)?

May 1992		Gallup Poll July 1989
51	Sense of identity	57
41	Just what they do for a living	40
3	Never worked - VOL.	--
5	Don't know/refused	3
100		100
		(669)

18. Thinking now about job opportunities where you live, would you say there are plenty of jobs available in your community or are jobs difficult to find?

May 1992		Jan 1992
16	Plenty of jobs available	12
77	Jobs are difficulty to find	79
4	Lots of some jobs, few of others (VOL.)	6
3	Don't know/refused	3
100		100

ASK Q. 19, 20 AND 21 ONLY OF EMPLOYED PEOPLE

19. And what about the job opportunities available to you. Do you think there are plenty of jobs in your line of work available in your community or are jobs in your line of work difficult to find?

May 1992	
32	Plenty of jobs available
63	Jobs are difficulty to find
2	Lots of some jobs, few of others (VOL.)
3	Don't know
100	
(852)	

20. How would you rate the financial condition of the company or organization that employs you. Would you say it is in excellent financial shape, good shape, only fair shape or in poor shape?

May 1992		Jan 1992
25	Excellent shape	22
40	Good shape	39
22	Only fair shape	24
11	Poor shape	12
2	Don't know/refused	3
100		100
(852)		(1,002)

21. Are you an employee of a private company or business, an employees of the federal, state or local government, or are you self-employed in your own business or professional practice?

May 1992		Gallup Poll July 1989
64	Employee of private company or business	62
20	Employee of federal, state or local government	23
15	Self-employed	14
1	Don't know/refused	1
100		100
(852)		(669)

ASK ALL:

22. How would you judge business conditions in your community? Would you say that local businesses are in excellent shape, good shape, only fair shape or poor shape?

May 1992		Jan 1992
3	Excellent shape	2
32	Good shape	25
49	Only fair shape	51
15	Poor shape	20
1	Don't know/refused	2
100		100

23. What's your impression about the real estate market in your community? Is it very easy, easy, difficult or very difficult for people in this community to sell their homes?

May 1992		Jan 1992
6	Very easy	3
28	Easy	19
43	Difficult	51
16	Very difficult	18
7	Don't know/refused	9
100		100

25. How easy is it for you and your family to afford (INSERT ITEM) -- very easy, easy, difficult or very difficult? (CONTINUE WITH REST OF LIST. ROTATE LIST. ALWAYS HAVE ITEM H FOLLOW G.)

	Very Easy	Easy	Diff.	Very Diff.	NA	DK
Food						
May 1992	12	66	18	3	*	1 = 100
Jan 1992	7	68	21	3	*	1 = 100
Clothing						
May 1992	9	56	26	6	2	1 = 100
Jan 1992	6	55	30	6	2	1 = 100
Housing						
May 1992	10	50	27	8	3	2 = 100
Jan 1992	7	55	27	7	3	1 = 100
Automobile						
May 1992	8	48	29	10	4	1 = 100
Jan 1992	5	46	31	11	6	1 = 100
Health care						
May 1992	10	42	29	15	3	1 = 100
Jan 1992	6	43	29	16	4	2 = 100
Saving for higher education						
May 1992	3	14	35	22	24	2 = 100
Jan 1992 **	1	13	32	22	30	2 = 100
Health insurance						
May 1992	9	39	30	16	5	1 = 100
Jan 1992	7	39	31	17	4	2 = 100
Other kinds of insurance						
May 1992	4	38	39	12	5	2 = 100
Jan 1992	4	37	38	12	7	2 = 100
Child care						
May 1992	3	17	16	7	54	3 = 100
Jan 1992	2	15	14	5	63	1 = 100
Taxes						
May 1992	4	30	46	15	3	2 = 100
Jan 1992	2	33	45	13	4	3 = 100
Saving for retirement						
May 1992	2	21	38	24	13	2 = 100
Jan 1992	2	22	37	23	14	2 = 100
Heating oil, gas and electric						
May 1992	9	54	28	6	1	2 = 100
Jan 1992	4	55	31	7	1	2 = 100

** Slight wording difference "Cost of higher education"

26. Thinking about job opportunities for Americans as a whole, please tell me if you feel the following proposals would help or hurt the job situation for Americans. First, would (INSERT ITEM) help the job situation a lot, help it a little, hurt it a little or hurt the job situation a lot? (ROTATE LIST) What about (CONTINUE ON WITH REST OF LIST)

	Help a Lot	Help a Little	Hurt a Little	Hurt a Lot	(VOL) No Effect	DK	
FORM 1 (n=600)							
Restricting the number of immigrants coming into the country each year	45	29	8	8	5	5	= 100
Increasing taxes on imported products	32	30	14	13	3	8	= 100
Spending more money on public education	59	27	5	2	3	4	= 100
Expanding job training opportunities	65	27	3	2	1	2	= 100
Reducing sex or race discrimination on the job	46	28	4	4	9	9	= 100
FORM 2 (n=600)							
Encouraging business and government to work more closely together	50	29	7	7	1	6	= 100
Reducing personal income taxes	37	33	11	6	4	9	= 100
Reducing the budget deficit	45	27	8	4	2	14	= 100
Cutting capital gains taxes on profits made from investments	24	33	15	7	4	17	= 100

27. Thinking about all of the different areas I just mentioned, which one of these would be most helpful to you, personally in advancing your job or career? (DO NOT READ LIST UNLESS ABSOLUTELY NECESSARY).

FORM 1

7	Restricting immigration
8	Increasing import taxes
29	Spending more money for education
27	Expanding job training
10	Reducing sex or race discrimination on the job
9	NONE OF THE ABOVE - VOL.
6	HAVE NO JOB OR CAREER - VOL. - GO TO Q. 29
*	OTHER
4	DON'T KNOW/REFUSED
100	

(600)

FORM 2

24	Encouraging business and government to work together
29	Reducing income taxes
15	Reducing the federal deficit
14	Cutting capital gains taxes
2	NONE OF THE ABOVE - VOL.
6	HAVE NO JOB OR CAREER - VOL. - GO TO Q. 29
1	OTHER
9	DON'T KNOW/REFUSED
100	

(600)

28. Which one of the candidates would do the best job of (INSERT ITEM 01 - 08 SELECTED IN Q. 27.), George Bush, Bill Clinton, or H. Ross Perot? (ACCEPT ONLY ONE ANSWER.)

	Bush	Clinton	Perot	None/ Same/ Other	DK	N
Restricting immigration	21	9	26	0	44	(41)
Increasing import taxes	18	22	36	7	17	(52)
Spending more money for education	22	28	20	9	21	(180)
Expanding job training	23	22	22	10	23	(161)
Reducing sex or race discrimination on the job	24	39	7	7	23	(60)
Encouraging business and government to work together	21	32	30	4	13	(145)
Reducing income taxes	20	20	28	12	20	(188)
Reducing the federal deficit	16	19	47	10	8	(93)
Cutting capital gains taxes	40	25	25	1	9	(84)

29. Do you own or rent your own home?

May 1992		Jan 1992
70	Own	65
26	Rent	26
4	Other arrangement	4
*	Don't know/refused	5
100		100

IF OWN IN Q. 29 ASK QUESTIONS NEXT TWO QUESTIONS. ALL OTHERS GO TO Q. 32.

30. Has the value of your home increase or decreased over the past few years. Would you say it increased a lot, increased a little, decreased a little, or decreased a lot?

May 1992		Jan 1992
21	Increased a lot	20
45	Increased a little	43
13	Decreased a little	14
10	Decreased a lot	7
8	Remained the same - VOL.	8
3	Don't know/refused	8
100		100
(846)		(995)

31. In the future, do you think the value of your home will increase a lot, increase a little, decrease a little or decrease a lot?

May 1992		Jan 1992
16	Increased a lot	14
55	Increased a little	52
17	Decreased a little	14
4	Decreased a lot	3
4	Remained the same - VOL.	7
4	Don't know/refused	10
100		100
(846)		(995)

On another subject..

X1 What do you think is the most important thing that the next President can do to improve the racial situation in this country? (READ)

23	Encourage private investment and business development in inner cities?
11	Provide more government assistance programs for blacks in inner cities?
34	Get tougher with criminals and drug dealers in inner cities?, OR
18	Develop programs and policies to keep black families together?
6	OTHER - VOL.
1	NOTHING - VOL - SKIP TO Q. X4
7	Don't know/ref
100	
(624)	

X2 What would be the next most important thing the next President can do to improve the racial situation? (RE-READ LIST IF NECESSARY. DO NOT ALLOW ANSWER IN X2 TO BE THE SAME AS ANSWER IN X1)

21	Encourage private investment and business development in inner cities?
12	Provide more government assistance programs for blacks in inner cities?
19	Get tougher with criminals and drug dealers in inner cities?, OR
24	Develop programs and policies to keep black families together?
3	OTHER - VOL.
1	NOTHING - VOL
5	Don't know/ref.
15	Not asked question
100	
(624)	

X3 Would you be willing to pay somewhat higher federal taxes to (INSERT ITEM 1 - 4 FROM X1) or not?

	Yes	No	DK	N
Encourage private investment and business development in inner cities?	51	41	8=100	(149)
Provide more government assistance programs for blacks in inner cities?	63	28	9=100	(69)
Get tougher with criminals and drug dealers in inner cities?	57	38	5=100	(204)
Develop programs and policies to keep black families together?	56	35	9=100	(120)

X4 Which of the Presidential candidates do you think would do the best job of making wise decisions about how to improve the racial situation in this country? (READ)

28 George Bush,

29 Bill Clinton, OR

18 Ross Perot

2 OTHER - VOL
23 Don't know
100
(624)

X5 Which of the Presidential candidates do you think would do the best job of developing effective programs to aid blacks?

26 George Bush,

33 Bill Clinton, OR

15 Ross Perot

3 OTHER - VOL
23 Don't know
100
(624)

X6 Which of the Presidential candidates do you think would do the best job of providing stricter law enforcement in inner city areas?

41 George Bush,

19 Bill Clinton, OR

18 Ross Perot

2 OTHER - VOL
20 Don't know
100

(624)
ASK ALL:

And finally, just a few background questions for statistical purposes...

32. In politics today, do you consider yourself a Republican, Democrat or Independent?

31	Republican -- SKIP TO 34
30	Democrat -- SKIP TO 34
34	Independent
2	Other
3	Don't know/refused - ASK Q. 33
100	

33. As of today do you lean more to the Republican Party or more to the Democratic Party?

INCLUDES SUPPORTERS AND LEANERS

46	Republican
44	Democratic
10	Other/Undecided
100	

34. How often would you say you vote (Democratic/Republican)? All the time, most of the time or only some of the time?

Rep/ Rep Lean	Dem/ Dem Lean	
20	25	All the time
48	41	Most of the time
28	28	Only some of the time
4	6	Don't know/refused
100	100	

35. If "1" represents someone who is very conservative in politics and "6" represents someone who is very liberal, where on this scale or 1 to 6 would you place yourself? (You may of course pick any number between 1 and 6

9	1	Very conservative
11	2	.
32	3	.
24	4	.
11	5	.
8	6	Very liberal
5		Don't know/refused
100		

36. In the election in November of 1988, when George Bush ran against Michael Dukakis, did things come up which kept you from voting, or did you happen to vote? For whom?

47	Bush
20	Dukakis
1	Other - VOL.
2	Voted, don't remember for whom
27	Did not vote
3	Don't know/refused
100	

37. Are you now registered to vote in your precinct or election district?

82	Yes
17	No
1	Don't know/refused
100	

40. How many children under the age of 18 are there in this household?

17	One
16	Two
6	Three
2	Four
*	Five or more
59	None
*	Don't know/refused
100	

41. How many adults in this household, including yourself, work full or part time?

30	One
41	Two
7	Three
3	Four or more
19	None
*	Don't know/refused
100	

42. What is your marital status -- are you married, divorced, separated, widowed, or never been married?

60	Married,
10	Divorced,
2	Separated,
7	Widowed, or
21	Never been married
*	Don't know/refused
100	

43. Are you or is your spouse a member of a labor union?

12	Yes respondent is
5	Yes spouse is
1	Yes both
81	Neither are
1	Don't know/refused
100	

44. What is your age?

25	18 - 29
39	30 - 49
18	50 - 64
17	65 and older
1	Don't know/refused
100	

45. What is the last grade or class that you completed in school? (DO NOT READ)

4	None, or grade 1 - 8
15	High school incomplete (Grades 9 - 11)
35	High school graduate, Grade 12
5	Technical, trade, or business after high school
20	College/university incomplete
13	College/university graduate
8	Some post-graduate training for an advanced degree, for example, a master's degree, Ph.D., law or medical degree
*	Don't know/refused
100	

46. Which of the following best describes the place where you live now? (READ)

18	In a large city?
23	In a suburb near a large city?
36	In a small city or town, or
22	In a rural area?
1	Don't know/refused
100	

47. Are you, yourself, of Hispanic origin or descent, such as Mexican, Puerto Rican, Cuban, or some other Spanish background?

6	Yes
94	No
*	Don't know/refused
100	

48. What is your race? Are you white, black, or some other? (IF RESPONDENT SAYS HISPANIC ASK: Do you think of yourself as a white hispanic or a black hispanic? CODE AS WHITE OR BLACK AS APPROPRIATE)

85	White
10	Black
3	Other
2	Don't know/refused
100	

49. Is your total annual household income before taxes $20,000 or more or is it less than $20,000?

(IF "UNDER" ASK:) Is it over or under $15,000?
(IF "UNDER" ASK:) Is it over or under $10,000?
(IF "OVER" ASK:) Is it over or under $30,000?
(IF "OVER" ASK:) Is it over or under $50,000?

29	Less than $20,000
19	$20,000 - $29,999
21	$30,000 - $49,999
21	$50,000 and over
10	Don't know/refused
100	

50. CHECK RESPONDENT'S SEX:

48	Male
52	Female
100→	